Tech Preparedness Quick Reference

Apps, offline maps, battery, and satellite SOS.

NAVIGATION APPS

AllTrails+ ($36/yr): Trail discovery + offline maps. Best for regular hikers. iOS and Android.

Gaia GPS ($40/yr): Serious backcountry topo maps. Used by SAR teams nationwide. iOS and Android.

onX Backcountry ($30/yr): Land ownership + hunting. Great offline topo maps. iOS and Android.

CalTopo ($50/yr): Trip planning + custom maps. Best for route analysis. iOS and Android.

Organic Maps (FREE): Open-source offline maps. No account, no ads, no tracking. iOS and Android.

FREE OFFLINE MAPS (already on your phone)

- ☐ Google Maps: Search area > menu > Download offline map. Expires in 30 days.
- ☐ Apple Maps (iOS 17+): Profile > Offline Maps > Download New Map.
- ☐ Organic Maps: Open app, zoom to area, auto-downloads. Free forever.

BATTERY + POWER

- ☐ Low Power Mode: Enable at trailhead. iPhone: Settings > Battery. Android: Battery Saver.
- ☐ Screen brightness: Reduce to 30-40%. #1 battery drain on any phone.
- ☐ Close apps: Swipe away social media and unused background apps.
- ☐ Airplane mode: ONLY if you have a separate satellite communicator. Otherwise leave cellular ON.
- ☐ Power bank: Day: 5K mAh (1 charge). Overnight: 10K. Multi-day: 20K mAh.
- ☐ Cold weather: Keep phone + bank in inside pockets near body. Cold cuts capacity 20-40%.

SATELLITE EMERGENCY + COVERAGE

- ☐ Satellite 911 texting: FREE for all carriers via T-Mobile/ Starlink (emergency 911 only). Full messaging: $10/mo.
- ☐ iPhone 14+ SOS: Built-in satellite SOS, no subscription. Practice in Settings > Emergency SOS.
- ☐ Garmin inReach: Two-way satellite texts + SOS with 24/7 monitoring. ~$15/mo. Best for backcountry.

Coverage maps are estimates. Actual signal varies with terrain, weather, and foliage. Most Cascade backcountry has NO cell service.

Scan a code or click a label to open the resource.

Satellite 911 Signup

T-Mobile Coverage

AT&T Coverage

Verizon Coverage